

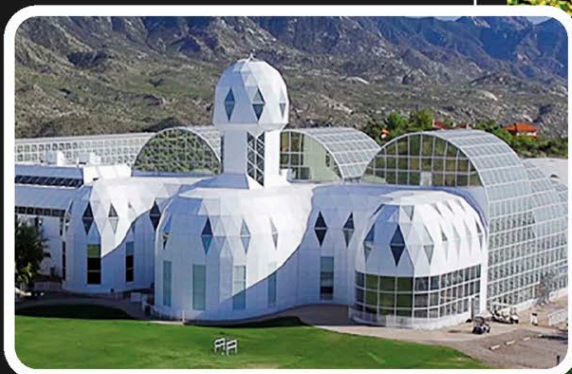
STUDYING HABITATS

BIOME DOMES

Earth's surface has many different habitats—from dry deserts to lush forests. Regions with a specific environment where a specialized range of plants and animals have adapted to live are called biomes. In order to study the organisms in these areas, scientists create artificial biomes. The Eden Project in Cornwall, UK, recreates biomes in enclosed domes. It aims to conserve vulnerable plants and raise awareness of the threats they face.

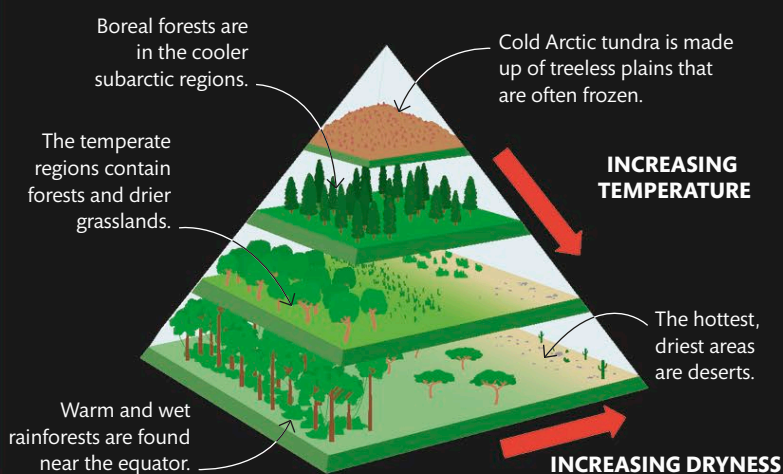
ECO EXPERIMENT

Biosphere 2 in Arizona was originally the site of an experiment to create a self-contained ecosystem involving seven biomes that could then be recreated in space. Humans, plants, and animals lived together for two years, but a sustainable ecosystem was not achieved.



BIOMES

On land, there are four major regions, shown in this pyramid—ranging from the hottest tropical regions to the colder Arctic regions. Factors such as rainfall, humidity, temperature, and altitude all impact the specific habitats within them.



Indoor jungle

With more than 1,000 plants, the giant temperature-controlled Rainforest Biome in The Eden Project recreates the conditions of four different environments: Tropical Islands, Southeast Asia, West Africa, and Tropical South America.

